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Dipak Kalariya
Through e-mail

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Simant Purohit
Through e-mail

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PIC-based Projects

I need projects based on PIC microcontrollers. I don't find PIC-based projects in EFY.

Mohit Gaikwad
Through e-mail

EFY: You may refer to the following PIC based projects published in EFY:

1. Voltage Stabiliser Using PIC PIC16F877A, August, 2010
2. PIC Microcontroller Based Electronic Lock, June, 2010
3. PIC16F877A Based Temperature Monitoring System, May, 2010
4. PIC16F84 Based Digital Thermometer, February, 2007
5. Dynamic Temperature Sensor and Controller Using PIC, Electronics Projects Vol. 25
6. Microcontroller Based 4-PIC16F84 Based Coded Device Switching System, Electronics Projects Vol. 25
7. PIC burner: The Programmer for PIC16XX Microcontrollers, Electronics Projects Vol. 23
8. R-2R D/A Converter Based Function Generator Using PIC16C84

Microcontroller, Electronics Projects Vol. 21

If interested, please contact our associates Kits'n'Spares on (011) 26371661 or at info@kitsnspares.com to get the book.

STK500 Board

You have published 'Interfacing Nokia Colour LCD With AVR Microcontroller' project in February issue, which requires STK500 board. STK500 board is not easily available. Please publish an alternative for STK500 board in your coming issue.

Nishant Mittal
Facebook

The author Prof. Arun Dayal Uday replies: STK500 board may be delivered to your institute under ATMEL University program free of charge. STK500 is a development board with clock and reset system meant for use with any ATMEL DIP-package microcontroller. The code demonstrated in different EFY projects is very well suited for your own development board with a specific ATMEL microcontroller.

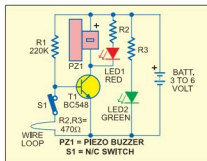
You can carry out the projects without using professional tools like STK500 etc. You may require a suitable programmer or a bootloader.

LCD interfacing was demonstrated on ATmega2560 generic board developed by me. You can use ATmega16 as well as ATmega32 for that purpose.

Pull-Pin Security Alarm

The circuit idea 'Pull-Pin Security Alarm' published in the March issue is a useful circuit, but quite complicated as it uses bulky components such as 12V battery and a relay. A much simpler circuit shown above can do the job.

When the wire loop is connected, the base of T1 gets grounded and little current flows in the piezobuzzer. If an attempt is made to steal the luggage, the wire loop gets broken. T1 now gets forward biased through R1, and piezobuzzer sounds an alarm. Also, the red LED glows. A closed switch S1 is used between the base and emitter of



Suggested pull-pin security alarm circuit

transistor T1 to test the working of the circuit. When the switch is opened, the alarm sounds.

Pradeep Vasudeva

The author T.K.Hareendran replies: The suggestion is not suitable for outdoor security purposes because of following reasons:

1. Sound from an ordinary 3-6V operated piezobuzzer is not loud enough to catch public attention.
2. There is no latching arrangement. The burglar can re-join the loop to stop the alarm, after lifting the luggage!
3. The design has improper transistor biasing. Indicator LEDs are operated above a 10mA current. Compact 12V rechargeable battery packs are easily available now. One such type is shown in the published circuit. The relay in the circuit will enhance its flexibility. The user can connect any desired alarm load at the output without circuit alteration. Further, in the published circuit, a stable loop-detection mechanism is built using a reliable MOSFET.

Solar Energy

In the 'Solar Energy to Our Rescue' article published in June issue, we were surprised that Solar Semiconductor did not appear in the 'Some PV Cell Players' list. For the future writing on the subject, you may want to correct your database! The photo of S.S.N. Prasad was not seen in the published article. Anyway, we look forward for a more dominant presence of Solar Semiconductor in your future stories on solar photovoltaic.

Ravi Surapaneni
Vice President, Solar Semiconductor Pvt Ltd, Hyderabad